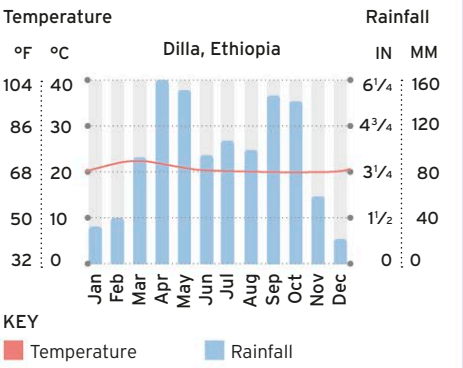




CLIMATE

Ethiopian highland climate is classed as tropical monsoon, but due to the region's elevation, temperatures are cooler here than would be expected this close to the equator. Rainfall increases from April to October, with the southwestern section receiving the most, while the annual average for the rest of the region is around 63in (1,600mm).



◁ JAGGED PEAKS

The rugged basalt cliffs and gorges of Ethiopia's Simien Mountains were created 30-20 million years ago by volcanic eruptions.

# The Cape Floral Region

*A biological hotspot, one of the most botanically diverse regions in the world, containing thousands of species found nowhere else*



Situated on the southwestern tip of South Africa, the Cape Floral Region is one of the country's eight World Heritage sites. This spectacular area covers just 4,227 square miles (10,947 square km) from the Cape Peninsula to the Eastern Cape—around 0.04 percent of Africa's landmass—yet it contains up to 20 percent of the entire continent's plant species. Of the Cape Floral Region's almost 9,000 plant species, a high percentage belong to the rare fynbos shrubland that makes up part of the area. Fynbos vegetation, which includes plants such as proteas and heathers, is found nowhere else on Earth outside South Africa; it thrives in the Cape's Mediterranean climate.

However, because many species are found only in localized, extremely small areas, this is a highly threatened, fragile environment, where just plowing a field or building a house can eradicate an entire species.

▽▷ BLOOM TIME

The term fynbos originates from a Dutch word meaning "fine-leaved plants." Fynbos plants include hundreds of protea species, such as the king protea (below), that bloom at varying times of year.

